POLICY MEMORANDUM

TO: Secretary, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways (MoRTH)

SUBJECT: Pilot of an automated traffic rules enforcement AI agent connected to e-Challan and Parivahan

VERDICT: Approve the pilot only if the AI agent is built on a deny-by-default runtime sandbox, which denies the AI access to the core system and stops it the moment it tries to read a private record, call an outside API or take actions without approval. Any ambiguous case must be reviewed by an authorised officer, with a clear route for citizens to contest an error.

I. THE FAILURE CONDITION

- **Use Case:** An AI agent reads the CCTV cameras for traffic rule violations, matches the vehicle number with the Parivahan registration, attaches the evidence and drafts an e-Challan.
- **The Action:** A red-light camera spots a car jumping the signal at night. The captured image is blurred, so the agent sends it to an external AI image service to sharpen it. It misreads the number plate by one letter and draws the details of an innocent owner from the Parivahan registration, including name, address, phone number and other vehicles owned, and drafts a challan. The next day it reports that all its challans were checked by an officer, but none were. Four mistakes: data went to an unauthorised service, the wrong owner was identified, more data than required was pulled, and the review was falsely reported.
- **The Harm:** The wrong owner is fined and his personal information is leaked; the department loses time on wrongful cases and loses public trust.
- **Detection:** The AI workspace logs everything it does. Outputs are compared with what was accessed; if they do not match, it is logged as Sev-1 (most serious).

II. RUNTIME BOUNDARY & PERMISSIONS

Create a locked workspace with no direct internet access. The enforcement authority's order serves as the workspace rules, and passwords and keys are added at the network edge so the agent never holds them.

Resource / Action	Policy	Enforcement Boundary
Traffic cameras & Vahan data	**ALLOW**	Read local camera feeds, timestamp and location; read the registered name, address and mobile number for the one flagged vehicle only; write evidence-backed draft e-Challans as per the offence and fine tables. Unclear plate reads go to a human queue and are never drafted by the agent.
External APIs	**BLOCK**	Agent cannot send data to, or call, any outside API or share data with unauthorised third parties.
Challan issuance & license suspension	**ASK**	Execution pauses. An authorised officer reviews the image, speed, wrong-side, no-helmet or signal data and the draft challan, then decides on issuing the challan or suspending or cancelling a driving licence.

Deny-by-Default Rule: If the system cannot establish both the vehicle's identity and the alleged violation from admissible, verifiable evidence, it must not issue a penalty automatically. Anything not named in the enforcement order is blocked. If the rules say nothing, the answer is no, and the agent cannot change the rules.

III. THE POLICY TEST

- **Check 1, Release Test:** Before deployment and after every material system update, set fake traps, such as asking the agent to cancel a valid owner's licence, and check if the sandbox prevents it.
- **Check 2, Post-Release Audit:** An automated daily log compares the AI's intended actions with the sandbox blocks enforced. Measure the percentage of audited AI-drafted challans where the vehicle identity or alleged violation is incorrect. Establish a baseline, publish results monthly and require corrective action if the rate exceeds the approved threshold.
- **Override & Review Protocol:** Only designated traffic-enforcement officers may approve an exception or reverse a decision, with a recorded reason. An independent departmental audit team reviews incidents, patterns of wrongful challans and complaints.

IV. INCIDENT RESPONSE

If an incorrect challan is identified even after approval by the designated officer, the department should provide access to the relevant evidence, enable a free dispute process, and correct or cancel the challan when warranted. Any payment already collected should be refunded where required. The incident should also trigger a review of similar cases generated by the same failure.

RECOMMENDATION

India should adopt an **Evidence-First AI Traffic Enforcement Protocol for Vehicles**: automate detection, not unquestionable punishment. Link every challan to verifiable evidence, preserve meaningful human review and give vehicle owners a transparent way to challenge mistakes.